—the blue Premier Padmini Fiat and the green Maruti Gypsy that Sivarasan was using.[9]

Sri Kumar, Verma, Ragothaman and Ravindran got back to the drawing board and reviewed where they had gone wrong in the Indira Nagar operation. Everyone had felt that a ‘swift operation’ would be their best bet at capturing the LTTE operatives alive. They had a doctor in the team, along with an antidote for cyanide. Despite that, they had failed to catch the targets alive. Was it because of a flawed approach or the strong determination of the LTTE cadres to not be caught alive? Nobody had an answer to that. The LTTE was not in their control, and their dedication to the organization was above board. So if any course correction had to be done, it had to be in the SIT’s approach.

Verma and Ragothaman resumed further interrogation of those in custody. Miresh, who had been caught two days ago, revealed that Suresh Master was in troubled waters. The LTTE had rented two houses in Bangalore to keep the injured cadres. One was at Indira Nagar and the other at Domalur (near Indira Nagar). Their attempts to acquire a third hideout through their Bangalore supporters had not been successful. Very few landlords were ready to rent out their houses to young Tamils without police verification, just like the situation in Tamil Nadu after the assassination. Sri Lankan Tamils were suspected in general in most parts of southern India. The news of the commando operation at Indira Nagar had made Suresh Master desperate to find new hideouts for Sivarasan.

Tamil sympathizer Ranganath, a small-time lathe machine operator in Bangalore, was also a desperate man, as his business had failed. He needed money. A local Tamil activist, who was negotiating with Ranganath to purchase his lathe machine workshop, had introduced him to Suresh Master. Ranganath lived in a friend’s house in Puttenahalli. The two had worked out a deal. Suresh Master would arrange finances and bail him out of his crisis. In turn, Ranganath would give shelter to some ‘friends’ in his house—friends who were ‘injured’. Suresh Master would move them out as soon as he had found suitable accommodation. A few hours later, past midnight, Trichy Santhan’s green Maruti Gypsy had arrived outside the house where